



A whale's journey

A journey of a whale's corpse at the bottom of the ocean and how it feeds numerous other species. <https://digit.in/Aug18-46-1>



Airbus' Mars Rover

Airbus has been granted \$5.2 million on a contract to develop a Mars rover to bring back soil samples. <https://digit.in/Aug18-46-2>

Teardown: MacBook Pro 2018 (Touch Bar)

A nightmare to upgrade and repair.

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More battery power

The battery capacity on the MacBook gets beefier from the previous model. Where it used to be only a 49.2 Wh unit, the current capacity has been boosted to 58 Wh. And this has been made possible by adding another battery cell, totalling up to six cells.



New keyboard trickery

Apple says that the new keyboard is quieter and that seems to have been implemented with the use of a silicone barrier above the butterfly switches. However, this design also matches their ingress-proofing patent. According to a report, Apple has actually confirmed that the membrane prevents debris from entering the switches. This should tackle the problem of dysfunctional keys plaguing users on the older generation keyboards.



Riveted keyboard base

The keyboard base sitting below the keycaps is riveted to the chassis with a few P2 pentalobe screws. This means it's a one-way trip when the keyboard is being repaired. It's also heavily glued to the frame with other components including the battery and speakers which means that they can't be separately repaired.



The T2 chip

Apple's custom T2 co-processor chip is used on the new Macbook Pro as well, earlier spotted on the iMac Pro. This chip takes over several functions such as image signal processing for the camera, hardware encryption, audio and SSD control, and more.